Value Stream Map

Map every step from request to customer, see where work waits, and design a faster future state.

Manage Flow · Inspired by Lean Value Stream Mapping (Rother & Shook) · Wait vs. Work Time · Flow Efficiency

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

VALUE STREAM: Story to live

DATE: 8 May

1 Scope

ONE STREAM, ONE TYPE OF WORK

Starts when: a story is agreed

Ends when: it's live for customers

Unit of work: one story

Measured over: the last 20 stories

2 Current State

PROCESS STEPS LEFT TO RIGHT · WAITS BETWEEN THEM

STEP 1

Name: Refine
Who: Priya + team
Work time: 2 h
% complete & accurate: 70%
People / WIP: 6

W wait 5 d

STEP 2

Name: Build
Who: Sam, Jo
Work time: 2 d
% complete & accurate: 90%
People / WIP: 3

W wait 1 d

STEP 3

Name: Review
Who: another dev
Work time: 1 h
% complete & accurate: 80%
People / WIP: 2

W wait 2 d

STEP 4

Name: Test
Who: Alex
Work time: 4 h
% complete & accurate: 85%
People / WIP: 2

W wait 3 d

STEP 5

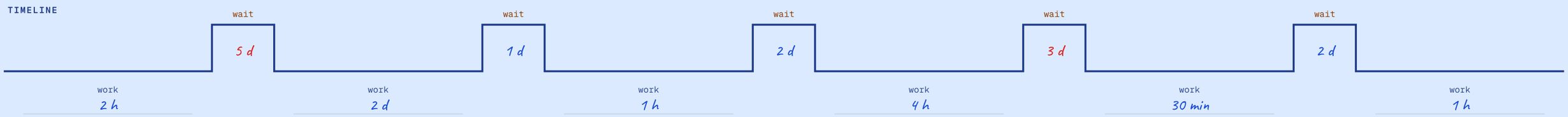
Name: Sign-off
Who: Payments lead
Work time: 30 min
% complete & accurate: 95%
People / WIP: 4

W wait 2 d

STEP 6

Name: Release
Who: Sam
Work time: 1 h
% complete & accurate: 90%
People / WIP: 1

TIMELINE



3 Totals

FLOW EFFICIENCY = WORK TIME / LEAD TIME

Lead time
first step to last
16 working days

Work time
sum of all steps
about 3 days

Flow efficiency
work / lead × 100
19%

Biggest wait
where and how long
5 days, waiting for planning

Most rework
lowest % C&A
Refine (70%)

4 Future State Ideas

REMOVE WAITS · REDUCE HAND-OFFS · BUILD QUALITY IN

- Self-service release checks: no sign-off wait
- Refine just in time: no 5-day wait
- Review the same day
- Platform owns one shared staging

5 Improvement Plan

CHANGE	OWNER	CHECK ON
Self-service release checks	Tom	16 May
Same-day review rule	Sam	next retro

"Where does work wait, and why?"

"What would it take to halve the lead time?"

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